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Current Affairs

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Chapter 1

Polity

1.1 Indian Constitution, Citizenship, Union and its Territory, FR, DPSP, FD

1.2 Executive, Legislature & Judiciary

1.3 Local Government, Constitutional Bodies, non-constitutional Bodies, Election

1.4 governance

1.5 bills

1.5.1 Transition from MGNREGA to VB-GRAM G Act, 2025: Analysis of Draft Rules

• Structural Changes: VB-GRAM G vs. MGNREGA:

1. **Employment Days:** Increases guaranteed rural wage employment from 100 days to **125 days** per year.
2. **Allocation Model:** Flips the bottom-up, demand-driven model of MGNREGA (based on state labor budgets) to a top-down “**Normative Allocation**” system determined by the Centre.
3. **Funding Devolution Formula:** Center will use the **16th Finance Commission’s** horizontal devolution recommendations to determine state-wise normative allocation.
4. **Fiscal Burden:** Moves away from the Center paying 100% of the wage bill under MGNREGA; shifts a significant portion of the funding burden onto states. States must bear 100% of any expenditure incurred in excess of their normative allocation.
5. **Agricultural Seasonal Clause:** Introduces a mandatory **60-day pause** during peak sowing and harvesting seasons to prevent rural farm labor shortages.
6. **Performance-Linked Allocations:** A portion of the normative fund will be kept aside and distributed based on state efficiency indicators: timely wage payments, compliance with social audits, and percentage of project completion within a financial year.

• Worker Transition Framework:

- **Card Validity:** Existing MGNREGA job cards remain valid for seeking employment under VB-GRAM G, provided they are renewed and verified through e-KYC. This acts as a transitional arrangement until state governments issue new **Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards**.
- **Continuity of Legal Guarantees:** Both the **Unemployment Allowance** and the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** mechanism into verified bank or post office accounts are retained.
- **Pending Clause:** The Union government is yet to declare the minimum wage rate under the new scheme.

• Critical Analysis & Concerns:

- **Dilution of Rights-Based Approach:** Shifting from a demand-driven model to a pre-fixed central normative allocation risks weakening the legal “right to work” tenet that formed the core of MGNREGA.
- **Implications for Fiscal Federalism:** Forcing states to bear excess expenditure beyond the top-down normative limit, combined with decreased allocations for historically proactive states, could trigger severe Centre–State fiscal friction.
- **Rural Wage Dynamics:** While the 60-day seasonal pause protects landowners by maintaining farm labor availability, it may restrict immediate alternative income generation for vulnerable landless laborers during transition windows.

1.6 judgements

1.6.1 Supreme Court Judgement on Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of Electoral Rolls

• Four Core Legal Issues Framed by the Court:

1. Whether the ECI possesses the structural

power to conduct the impugned SIR.

2. Whether the SIR is founded on a legitimate purpose, and whether the adopted measures are proportionate to the object sought to be achieved.
3. Whether the procedure adopted is contrary to, or in violation of, the provisions of the *Representation of the People Act, 1950* and the *Registration of Electors Rules, 1960*.
4. Whether, under its constitutional mandate to prepare and maintain ERs, the ECI is empowered to scrutinize the citizenship status of individuals seeking inclusion or continuation in the rolls.

• **Key Supreme Court Observations & Remarks:**

1. **Intersection of Constitutional Concerns:** The SC noted that the issue rests at the intersection of two constitutional duties: including all eligible citizens, and ensuring that the ER reflects the true composition of the political community.
2. **Institutional Deference:** The Court delivered a complete "clean chit" to the ECI, characterizing its process and methodology as "**optimal**". It observed that it is not open to the Court to supplant its own judgment in matters concerning execution for which the ECI is endowed with specialized "**institutional expertise**".
3. **Systemic Nature of Errors:** The Court was convinced that cumulative inaccuracies over an extended period had become systemic in nature. It recognized that such deep-seated inaccuracies require a comprehensive SIR because they do not readily admit to piecemeal or localized solutions.
4. **Limited Inquiry vs. Citizenship Finality:** The SC explicitly reaffirmed that while the ECI is empowered to undertake a limited inquiry into citizenship to satisfy voter eligibility, this does not equal a final legal determination of citizenship in a strict sense. It merely reflects the ECI's contextual inability to be satisfied for electoral inclusion, leaving the voter's ultimate claim to citizenship open

for competent statutory adjudication.

5. **Test of Proportionality:** The Court held that the exercise successfully met the parameters of proportionality, as it integrated sufficient procedural safeguards to prevent arbitrary or widespread disenfranchisement. Post-exercise data did not demonstrate any systemic constitutional infirmity in design.

• **Directions Issued to the Election Commission of India (ECI):**

1. **Mandatory Reference Window:** The ECI is legally bound to disclose the exact count of "ineligible" persons discovered through the SIR and refer their names to the competent authority under the *Citizenship Act, 1955* within a strict **four-week** deadline for formal citizenship adjudication.
2. **Strict Pre-election Timeline:** This adjudication must be completed by the competent authority, following due notice and hearings, **before** the next impending Parliamentary, Legislative Assembly, or Local Body elections in the respective state or constituency.
3. **Accountability and Public Disclosure:** Having received judicial backing, the ECI is now expected to present a complete, transparent report card comparing the post-SIR health of the electoral rolls (on parameters of integrity, accuracy, and purity) against prior rolls.

• **Critical Concerns and "Structural Correctives":**

1. **The Evolution of Safeguards:** The SC admitted that the SIR process, as initially designed, did raise legitimate concerns regarding documentation, transparency, and access.
2. **Judicial Infusion of Fairness:** The Court highlighted that its own progressive, interim interventions served as vital structural correctives. These interventions forced the ECI to adopt more inclusive standards, such as:
 - (a) Treating the **Aadhaar card** as an additional, valid 12th document of identity verification.

(b) Mandating the public disclosure of the draft roll containing approximately **65 lakh excluded electors** in Bihar, accompanied explicitly by the individual reasons for their deletion, ensuring a verifiable and contestable administrative process.

3. **The Scale of Deletions vs. Access to Justice:** Critical observers (including former election commissioners) note that while the court order delivers a massive legal victory to the ECI, massive hurdles remain for the affected populace. Hundreds of thousands of deleted individuals—such as the massive block of over **27 lakh electors excluded in West Bengal**—face immense logistical hardships while navigating the appellate process and waiting for structural justice.

1.7 miscellaneous

Chapter 2

Economy

2.1 Pillar 1: Money, Banking, Finance & Insurance

2.2 Pillar 2: Budget, Taxation & Public Finance

2.3 Pillar 3: Balance of Payments (BoP) & International Trade

2.4 Pillar 4: Sectors of Economy, GDP & Inflation

2.5 Pillar 5: Infrastructure

2.5.1 The Great Nicobar Project: Strategic, Economic and Ecological Framework

- **Context & Strategic Significance:**

1. Aimed at transforming Great Nicobar into a strategic maritime and economic hub in the Indian Ocean Region, strengthening India's presence in the Andaman Sea and Southeast Asia.
2. Seeks to capture transshipment trade currently lost to foreign ports like Colombo, Singapore, and Klang due to India's lack of deep-water berths.

- **Core Infrastructure Components:**

1. **International Container Transshipment Terminal (ICTT):** Located at Galathea Bay with a capacity of 14.2 million Twenty-Foot Equivalent Units (TEU).
2. **Greenfield International Airport:** Designed to handle 4,000 Peak Hour Passengers (PHP), projecting an initial 1 million passengers annually, scaling up to 10 million.
3. **Township and Area Development:** A planned urban center spanning 16,610 hectares to support port-led residential, commercial, and institutional requirements.
4. **Power Plant:** A 450 MVA hybrid gas and solar-based power plant designed with N-1 contingency (redundancy) to phase out diesel generators and reduce emissions.

- **Forest Diversion & Compensatory Afforestation:**

1. Diverts 1.82% of the total forest cover of the A&N Islands.
2. Preservation of 65.99 sq. km of land as strict green zones within the project area.

- **Tribal Welfare & Rights Protection:**

1. Inhabited by Particular Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs): Shompens (≈ 237 , hunter-gatherers) and Nicobarese ($\approx 1,094$, coastal fishing communities).
2. **No Displacement/Relocation:** Project aligns with the Shompen Policy (2015), Jarawa Policy (2004), and Article 338A(9) of the Constitution. No tribal habitations are being relocated.
3. **Tribal Reserve Land Balance:** 84.10 sq. km overlaps with the current Tribal Reserve. Within this, 11.032 sq. km is already utilized as revenue land since 1972. Thus, 73.07 sq. km is being de-notified for the project. To balance this, 76.98 sq. km is being re-notified as Tribal Reserve, creating a **net addition of 3.912 sq. km** to the reserve area.

2.6 Pillar 6: Human Resource Development (HRD)

Chapter 3

Environment

3.1 Environmental Laws and policies

3.2 Climate Change, Carbon Credit, ETS

3.3 Environmental Convention and bodies

3.4 Pollution

3.5 Biodiversity

3.6 Protected Areas

3.7 Species

3.7.1 Rediscovery of *Gynacantha khasiaca* (Long-tailed Duskhawker)

- **Context & Rediscovery:**

- A rare dragonfly species, *Gynacantha khasiaca* (commonly known as the long-tailed duskhawker), has resurfaced in the Changlang district of Arunachal Pradesh (**Namdapha National Park and Tiger Reserve**).

- **About Dragonflies:**

1. Possesses two large compound eyes, each comprised of thousands of tiny lenses and photoreceptor clusters.
2. Features a near-360° field of vision and possesses the distinct behavioral trait of being able to hover perfectly still in mid-air.
3. They serve as critical bioindicators and components of freshwater ecosystems, functioning simultaneously as apex invertebrate predators and vital prey within the aquatic food web.
4. long-tailed duskhawker has also been historically documented across Assam, Meghalaya, West Bengal, Uttarakhand, and Maharashtra.

3.8 Miscellaneous

Chapter 4

International Relations

4.1 Groupings

4.2 Major Initiatives and Agreements

4.2.1 Pax-Silica Initiative (US-led)

- **Led by:** US Department of State
- **Objective:** Secure a resilient, trusted supply chain for ACES (AI, Critical minerals, Electronics & Semiconductors).
- **India's Involvement:** India signed in during the India AI Impact Summit.
- **Latest Member:** Sweden
- **Member Nations:** Australia, Japan, ROK (Republic of Korea), UK, Singapore, Qatar, UAE, Greece, Israel, India, and Sweden.
- **Total Members:** 11

4.3 Bilateral Relations

4.4 India and the World

4.4.1 India's West Asia Policy: Framework, Interventions, and Strategic Balancing

- **Core Pillars of Strategic Engagement:**
 1. **Energy Security:** Heavy reliance on regional crude oil and gas imports.
 2. **Human Security & Economy:** Protection of the massive Indian diaspora, safeguarding remittance inflows, and attracting sovereign wealth investments.
 3. **Geopolitics & Trade:** Critical for maritime shipping lanes, regional connectivity nodes, and defense/counter-terrorism partnerships.
- **The "Rubik's Cube" Diplomacy (Tri-Directional Balancing):**
 1. **Israel Pillar:** Anchored in core national security, defense procurement, advanced technology transfers, intelligence sharing, and counter-terrorism cooperation.
 2. **Gulf States Pillar (Saudi Arabia, UAE):** Vital economic, investment, energy, and food

security partners. Requires handling Gulf countries as distinct actors rather than a single homogeneous bloc.

3. **Iran Pillar:** Critical for continental connectivity, developing the strategic **Chabahar Port**, and maintaining alternative transit access to Afghanistan and Central Asia.

- **Emerging Regional Vulnerabilities & Security Interconnections:**

1. **Cascading Geopolitical Crises:** Interconnected flashpoints including the Gaza conflict, US-Iran tensions, and multi-front militia activities (e.g., in Lebanon).
2. **Maritime Security Risks:** Direct threats to trade and shipping routes in the Red Sea and Arabian Sea, causing cascading global impacts on supply lines.

- **Direct Macroeconomic and Social Impact on India:**

1. **Fiscal Strains:** Regional volatility directly triggers spikes in imported oil and fertilizer prices, depleting foreign exchange reserves and aggravating exchange-rate volatility.
2. **Expatriate Welfare:** Instability creates physical and economic security anxieties among the Indian expatriate worker communities.
3. **Commercial Disruptions:** Trade bottlenecks and maritime commerce delays directly affect India's export-import schedules.

- **Strategic Autonomy & Foreign Policy Way Forward:**

1. **De-hyphenated Engagement:** Rejection of exclusive alignment with either the Israeli or Arab blocs; absolute prioritization of multi-aligned strategic autonomy.
2. **Dialogue Maintenance:** Preserving multi-stakeholder diplomatic access while systematically avoiding strategic overcommitment

to any single regional sub-rivalry.

3. **"Access over Visibility" Doctrine:** Emphasizing high-yield backchannel diplomacy, quiet engagement, and continuous communication lines over public positioning or highly visible, polarising declarations during active conflicts.

4.4.2 India-Netherlands Strategic Partnership (2026–2030): Framework and Outcomes

• Context & Institutional Evolution:

- **Bilateral Elevation:** During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the Netherlands (May 2026), relations were formally elevated to a **"Strategic Partnership"** for the period 2026–2030.
- **Strategic Convergence:** Shifting from conventional trade ties to a high-technology partnership of **"innovation meets scale"** matching Dutch frontier tech with India's deployment capacities.

• Macroeconomic & Investment Footprint:

- **Trade Balance:** India maintains a substantial trade surplus of USD 17.393 billion (INR 144,095 crores).
- **FDI Inflows:** The Netherlands is India's **4th largest investor** with a cumulative Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) inflow of USD 55.6 billion.
- **Corporate Presence:** Over 300 Dutch enterprises operate in India, matched by over 300 Indian firms active in the Netherlands, facilitated by the Netherlands India Chamber of Commerce & Trade (NICCT) and Indian Business Chamber (IBC).

• Core Strategic Deliverables & Industrial Outcomes:

1. **Semiconductor Ecosystem (Tata Electronics – ASML Collaboration):** Direct technological linkage forged under the India Semiconductor Mission to support the setup of India's commercial semiconductor fabrication unit (FAB) at Dholera, Gujarat. Focuses heavily on collaborative R&D, specialized startup mentorship, and workforce

skilling.

2. **Green Hydrogen & Energy Transition:** Institutionalization of the *Roadmap on Green Hydrogen* to expand Indian derivative exports to European markets and attract FDI for storage, ports, and electrolyzer infrastructure. Supported by a NITI Aayog–Netherlands renewed statement of intent on capacity building for energy transition.

3. **Joint Working Group (JWG) on Renewable Energy:** Newly established bilateral group targeting operational safety and industrial scale-up across bioenergy, battery storage, circular feedstocks, and bio-chemicals.

4. **Critical Minerals Supply Chain Security:** Agreement signed to streamline supplies of strategic raw materials, upgrade extraction technologies, and boost sovereign mining and processing outputs in India.

5. **Mega Coastal Engineering (Kalpasar Project, Gujarat):** Specialized technical agreement leveraging Dutch expertise in coastal engineering to build a massive freshwater reservoir across the Gulf of Khambhat for agricultural, industrial, and drinking use, incorporating tidal power and transport links.

6. **Trade Facilitation via Customs Agreement:** Signing of the *Customs Mutual Administrative Assistance Agreement* to secure bilateral trade logistics, combat tax evasion, improve regulatory enforcement, and lower export costs.

• Agricultural, Health, and Educational Interventions:

– Agrarian Centers of Excellence (CoE):

- * *Floriculture:* Setup of the Indo-Dutch CoE for Flowers in West Tripura to introduce high-value floriculture practices, improve cold-chain storage, and expand export infrastructure.
- * *Dairying:* Setup of the Indo-Dutch CoE for Dairy Training at the existing Center of Excellence for Animal Husbandry

(CEAH) in Bengaluru to raise livestock productivity, reinforce veterinary diagnostics, and control zoonotic diseases.

- **Public Health Alliance (ICMR – RIVM):** Dynamic collaboration framework between the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) and the Dutch National Institute for Public Health and the Environment (RIVM) targeting infectious diseases, digital health tools, antimicrobial resistance (AMR), and climate-health impacts.

- **Higher Education Partnerships:** Broad framework supporting joint/dual degree roll-outs to enhance student-faculty mobility. Specifically includes an academic exchange and interdisciplinary research pact between Nalanda University and the University of Groningen.

- **Cultural Diplomacy and Diasporic Welfare:**

- **Chola Artefact Repatriation:** Diplomatic restitution of 11th-century Chola Copper Plates (royal charters inscribed in Tamil and Sanskrit recording the land grant of Anaimangalam village to a Buddhist vihara in Nagapattinam), marking a major milestone for cultural heritage diplomacy.
- **Historical Archival Research:** Institutional pact between Leiden University Libraries and the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) to enable shared research, manuscript preservation, and archival study focused on the Chola period.
- **Diaspora Framework & Skilled Mobility:** Streamlining migration pathways for the 240,000-strong Indian diaspora in the Netherlands (the second-largest in Europe after the UK), which features approximately 20,000 integrated members of the Hindustani-Surinami community. Includes fast-tracking flexible visa processing and setting up student internship pipelines.

4.5 UN and It's agreements

4.6 Miscellaneous

4.6.1 Medical and Wellness Tourism in India

- **Global Market Trends:**

1. The global MVT market, valued at USD 115.6 billion in 2022, is projected to expand to USD 286.1 billion by 2030 at a CAGR of 10.8%.
2. India's domestic medical tourism footprint was valued at USD 8.7 billion in 2025 and is projected to scale up to USD 16.2 billion by 2030.
3. According to the Medical Tourism Index (MTI) 2020–21, India ranks **10th** globally in medical tourism, **12th** in wellness tourism markets, and **5th** in the Asia-Pacific region for wellness.

- **The Core Pillars of India's MVT Framework: Heal In India**

1. **Medical Tourism (Curative Care):** Focuses on complex, high-end surgical procedures, organ transplants, advanced diagnostics, and clinical interventions.
2. **Wellness Tourism (Proactive/Preventive Care):** Centered around therapeutic, preventive health via traditional systems including Yoga, Ayurveda, Naturopathy, and other AYUSH practices.

- **India's Structural and Quality Competitive Edge:**

1. **Resource Base:** Backed by 69,364 hospitals (43,486 private; 25,778 public) and 1.2 million registered doctors, fulfilling the WHO-recommended doctor-to-population ratio. English-medium clinical training removes language barriers.
2. **Accreditation Standards:** As of 2026, the National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers (NABH) has accredited over 1,299 hospitals across 600+ safety parameters. NABH is affiliated with the International Society for Quality in Healthcare (ISQua).
3. **Cost-Effective Medical Treatment:** India's medical tourism appeal is significantly strengthened by its cost competitiveness, offering high-quality treatment at a substan-

tially lower cost compared to many developed countries while maintaining comparable clinical standards.

4. **Strengthening AYUSH-led Medical Value Travel:**

- **Unique Wellness Advantage:** India leverages its traditional systems of medicine—Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, and Homeopathy (AYUSH)—promoting them as integral components of holistic health and preventive care.
- **AYUSH Visa Facilitation:** To streamline access, a dedicated AYUSH Visa category was introduced on July 27, 2023, allowing foreign nationals and their attendants to travel specifically for recognized traditional treatments.
- **Quality Standards:** To enhance credibility and standardization, the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) has officially adopted the international standard ISO 22525 for medical wellness tourism services.
- **Insurance Coverage:** Under IRDAI regulations, insurance coverage has expanded to AYUSH therapies, with around 27 insurance companies currently offering more than 140 policy products.
- **Global Engagement & Capacity Building:** MVT remains a central theme across major forums, including the "Global Synergy in AYUSH" Summits in Mumbai (2024) and Chennai (May 2025). Workforce development is supported by the AYUSH sub-council under the Health Sector Skill Council.
- **Global Outreach:** Outreach continues to expand through platforms like the WHO Global Traditional Medicine Summit, the Know India Programme, and designated showcases during the Maha Kumbh Mela 2025.

Budget 2026–27):

1. **Regional Medical Hubs:** Plan to set up **five** Regional Medical Hubs via Public-Private Partnership (PPP) to establish integrated complexes housing healthcare, research, AYUSH facilities, and MVT Facilitation Centres under one roof.
2. **Traditional Medicine Infrastructure:** Announcement of **three** new All India Institutes of Ayurveda. Simultaneously, the WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre in Jamnagar is being upgraded to enhance global clinical research.

• **Policy, Governance & Digital Facilitation:**

1. **Dedicated Visa Regime:** Introduction of specific **e-AYUSH Visa** and **e-AYUSH Attendant Visa** categories (launched July 27, 2023) alongside conventional e-Medical visas extended to 172 countries.
2. **Standardization & Insurance Integration:** Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) adopted the international ISO 22525 standard for wellness tourism. IRDAI framework has successfully onboarded ≈27 insurance firms offering over 140 policy products covering AYUSH treatments.
3. **Governance Bodies:** The National Medical & Wellness Tourism Promotion Board (NMWTB) acts as an apex inter-ministerial coordinator under the Ministry of Tourism.
4. **Capacity Building:** A pilot project under the 2026–27 Budget targets upskilling 10,000 guides at 20 iconic locations with a 12-week course. Paramedical staffs are being formally trained in cross-cultural sensibilities and foreign languages.

• **Budgetary and Strategic Initiatives (Union**

Chapter 5

Science and Technology

5.1 Space Tech

5.2 Defence Tech

5.3 IT and communication Tech

5.4 Health

5.5 Energy

5.6 Bio Tech

5.7 Nuclear Tech

5.8 Miscellaneous

5.8.1 Major Chemistry Breakthrough: Carbon-Free Sandwich Molecule

- **The Breakthrough:** Researchers at **IIT Madras** and the **Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru**, have achieved a major chemistry breakthrough by synthesizing a completely **carbon-free** molecule that replicates the unique sandwich structure of the famous carbon-containing **ferrocene** molecule.

Comparative Analysis: Ferrocene vs. The New Molecule

Traditional Ferrocene	New Carbon-Free Molecule
Iron (Fe) atom at center	Osmium (Os) atom at center
Flat carbon-ringed molecules	Boron-based flanking rings
High carbon reliance	Completely Carbon-free
Standard organometallic bond	Exceptionally strong bonding
Used in medicines, batteries, and electronics	Potential for engineering novel, highly robust materials

Chapter 6

Internal Security

Chapter 7

Miscellaneous
